Pav Rao

Former Full-Stack Developer | Senior Advertising Creative | Physics with Astrophysics Graduate
London · 07799 113911 · pav0107@gmail.com · LinkedIn · GitHub · Product portfolio · Advertising portfolio

SUMMARY

As a full-stack developer, I learned how products are built and how product managers, engineers and designers work together to ship them. As an advertising creative, I came up with original ways to sell products, built on insights into both the product and the people who use it, and learned how to win buy-in from senior stakeholders. I'm currently in the midst of King's College London's Product Management Career Accelerator course and spend my spare time building my own AI tools and apps.

SKILLS

- **Product & research:** creative problem-solving, research and insight, idea generation, prototyping, user interviews, selling ideas to senior stakeholders
- **Technical background:** first-hand experience of how web products are built, tested and shipped. Used PHP (Laravel, Livewire), Alpine.js, Tailwind CSS, MySQL and Git as a developer at Mumsnet, and JavaScript, React and Next.js on personal projects
- **Tools & ways of working:** Agile ways of working (stand-ups, estimation, backlog refinement), cross-functional teams, Figma, Trello
- **AI:** building personal AI agent workflows, such as an automated weekly newsletter digest using Claude and Gmail.

EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer, Mumsnet 2021 – 2023

- Built and shipped new features, bug fixes and performance optimisations for one of the UK's largest online communities: 32 million monthly unique visitors and 1.6 billion requests a month, peaking at 2,400 per second.
- Worked in a small Agile team alongside product managers and designers: took part in daily stand-ups, estimated proposed work to help refine and prioritise it, and turned user stories into working features.
- Stack: Laravel, Livewire, Alpine.js, Tailwind CSS, MySQL.

Advertising Creative (Copywriter) 2006 – 2021, 2023 – 2026

Worked in ad agencies, branding consultancies and design studios, in both permanent and freelance roles, at AMV, Dentsu, GOOD, Grey, Euro RSCG and This is Real Art, amongst others, including five years in-house at Macmillan Cancer Support.

- Developed campaigns and brand work for clients including Honda, Nokia, Google, Reckitt Benckiser, London Business School, Macmillan Cancer Support, Marie Curie, Crisis, Cats Protection, RNIB, Virgin Media, RSPB and Reprieve.
- On some projects, ran in-depth interviews with people living with cancer, people with learning disabilities, survivors of torture and London Business School alumni, amongst others, to uncover insights that formed the foundation of campaigns.
- In-house at Macmillan: made editorial decisions on the quarterly supporter magazine, designed and ran organisation-wide workshops ("Writing for Macmillan" and "Brand and Be.Mac") to help teams apply the brand and its tone of voice consistently, and worked with internal stakeholders to understand their needs.
- Pitched ideas to stakeholders, from internal teams to senior clients, handling feedback and objections to get the work bought.

- Collaborated with art directors, designers, photographers and directors across TV, digital, social, press, posters, direct mail, radio, film and events.
- Generated new business, while freelancing, by proactively approaching potential clients.

PROJECTS

Personal Training App · Case study

- Designed and built a browser-based app to plan and properly log my own training, replacing the Excel spreadsheet I'd previously used. Data syncs to a private GitHub Gist, so it can't be lost.
- Built iteratively with Claude, adding features as I used it, including a guided timer with colour-coded intervals, audio cues and linked demo videos.

AI Newsletter Roundup · Case study

- Built an automated weekly email that turns 16 AI newsletters into one short, practical roundup, using Claude and Gmail.
- Split product management into its own roundup after the first week, because the two were doing different jobs.

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Stand-Up Comedian 2011 – 2019

- Performed across the UK and Europe to audiences of up to 500 people.
- Won Bath Comedy Festival's New Act of the Year and reached the semi-final of the BBC New Comedy Awards.

EDUCATION

Product Management Career Accelerator, King's College London Nov 2026 – May 2027
In progress. Product discovery, user research, prioritisation, Agile delivery, product metrics, roadmapping, pricing, go-to-market and managing AI products, plus a six-week Employer Project.

MSci Physics with Astrophysics, University of Bristol 1998 – 2002

Software Development Bootcamp, Makers 2021

Google AI Essentials and Google Prompting Essentials (Coursera) 2025

Copywriting and Art-direction, Watford College 2005 – 2006